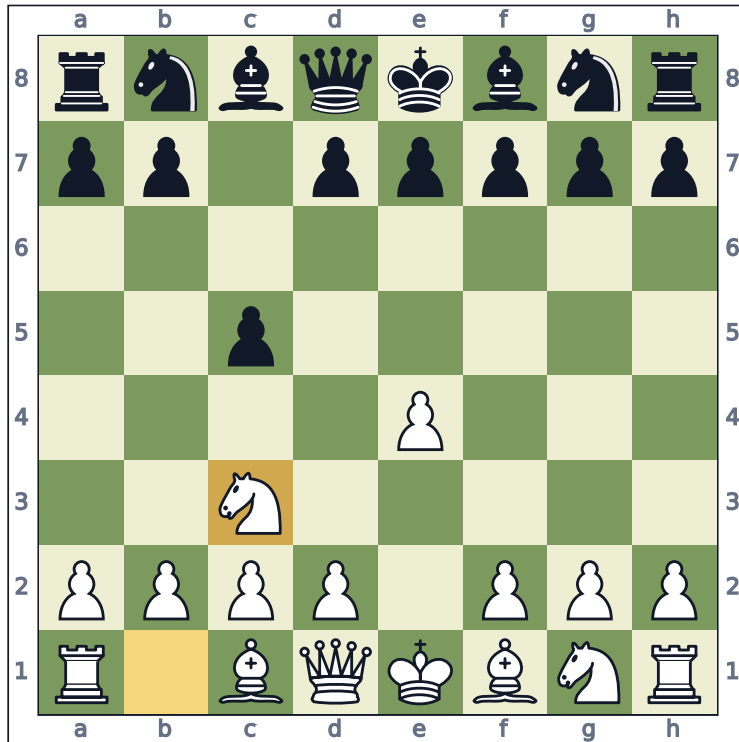


SICILIAN DEFENSE

Sicilian Defense

ECO B23 | 11 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.42 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Unbalanced and ambitious: both sides usually receive active plans and real winning chances.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B23 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: Closed.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

BLACK'S GOALS

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B23 line

This section preserves all 11 names and defining routes assigned to B23 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Sicilian Defense: Closed

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3

002 Sicilian Defense: Closed

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 e6

003 Sicilian Defense: Closed

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 e6 3. g3

004 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Carlsen Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Qxd4 Nc6 5. Qd2

005 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Chameleon Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. Nge2

006 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Grob Attack

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. g4

007 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Korchnoi Defense

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 e6 3. g3 d5

008 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Portland Attack

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. d3 g6 4. g4

009 Sicilian Defense: Closed, Traditional

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B23 line

This section preserves all 11 names and defining routes assigned to B23 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Sicilian Defense: Grand Prix Attack

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4

011 Sicilian Defense: Grand Prix Attack, Schofman Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. f4 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. Bc4 e6 6. f5